

PAINFUL PERIODS & CRAMPS

Key points

- Cramps often start just before or at the start of bleeding and may spread to the back or thighs.
- If pain is severe, worsens over time, or does not improve with typical measures, another cause may need to be checked.
- Endometriosis is one important cause of severe period pain.

When to seek care

- Pain causing missed school or work
- Pain that keeps worsening
- Pain with heavy bleeding, vomiting, fainting, or pain outside the period window

Key Takeaway

Severe pain is not something to ignore- it may need medical evaluation.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

Educational content informed by American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. (n.d.). Dysmenorrhea: Painful periods. ACOG. <https://www.acog.org/womens-health/faqs/dysmenorrhea-painful-periods> Itani, R., Soubra, L., Karout, S., Rahme, D., & Karout, L. (2022). Primary dysmenorrhea: Pathophysiology, diagnosis, and treatment updates. Korean Journal of Family Medicine, 43(2), 101–108. <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8943241/> American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. (n.d.). Endometriosis. ACOG. <https://www.acog.org/womens-health/faqs/endometriosis>